AI-Powered Data Analysis Report

Digital Education and the Learning Gap in India

Prepared: 26 October 2026

1. Objective

To explore how digital education can support more equitable learning in India, using published school-infrastructure statistics to identify progress, gaps, and practical actions for NGOs and volunteers.

2. Key Findings

• Internet access in Indian schools rose from 53.9% in 2023–24 to 63.5% in 2024–25, an increase of 9.6 percentage points. (Ministry of Education / Press Information Bureau)

• Schools reporting computer access increased from 57.2% in 2023–24 to 64.7% in 2024–25, a rise of 7.5 percentage points. (Ministry of Education / Press Information Bureau)

• NITI Aayog's analysis of UDISE+ 2024–25 data reports that around 50.7% of schools in Karnataka had internet facilities. This shows that a state known for its technology sector still has a significant school-connectivity gap. (NITI Aayog)

• These figures measure the availability of facilities, not whether every student has a device at home, reliable connectivity, accessible learning content, or improved learning outcomes.

3. Analysis and Insights

The data suggests that digital infrastructure is improving, but access remains uneven. Roughly 36.5% of schools nationally still did not report internet facilities in 2024–25. Connectivity alone is also insufficient: schools need functioning devices, electricity, teacher training, suitable local-language content, and ongoing technical support. If these conditions are missing, online learning may benefit already-connected students more than learners facing disadvantage.

4. How AI Can Help

AI tools can speed up research by locating relevant reports, summarise long documents, compare year-on-year figures, and suggest questions for further investigation. In this report, AI was used to organise the topic, calculate percentage-point changes, and draft the analysis. Important statistics were checked against government sources. AI-generated summaries should not be treated as evidence by themselves; figures need to be checked against the original publication and the year/definition confirmed.

5. Recommendations for NGOs

• Conduct a local needs assessment before distributing devices: check connectivity, device availability, language needs, accessibility, and teacher support.

• Pilot shared digital-learning sessions at community centres or schools, with offline resources for low-connectivity areas.

• Train volunteers and teachers to use digital resources safely and effectively.

• Track meaningful outcomes—not only devices distributed—including attendance, usage, learner confidence, and changes in basic reading or numeracy.

• Protect children's privacy and use age-appropriate, accessible content.

Conclusion

Digital education can widen learning opportunities, but only when technology is accessible, reliable, and connected to good teaching. NGOs can make a practical difference by combining digital resources with community support and measuring whether learners actually benefit.

Sources (accessed 26 October 2026)

1. Press Information Bureau, Government of India — school infrastructure, UDISE+ 2024–25 (internet and computer access)
https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2161543⟨=2®=3

2. NITI Aayog — School Education in India: A Temporal Analysis and Policy Roadmap (UDISE+ 2024–25; state-level connectivity)
https://www.niti.gov.in/node/2288

3. UDISE+ — official school education data portal, Ministry of Education
https://www.udiseplus.gov.in/